

What I built. An image upload zone, from a Figma exploration of a 6×6 glass-block grid. When idle, a blue mass moves behind the glass and leans toward your cursor. Drag a file over it and the camera pulls in; let go and the mass spreads out to fill the zone while the level climbs behind the tiles. When it lands, your image comes up through the liquid. It rests at centre, then leaves through the top and the field gathers back into an orb. A file that's too big, or a connection that dies halfway, turns the same liquid red.

The detail I'm proud of. I love experimental design and this is one of the coolest looking upload zone I've seen. However, I didn't know which glass would feel right, so I built a bench at `/test` and made three versions of it. One draws the glass in the shader itself. One is 36 divs with CSS filters. One is 36 real 3D cubes that actually bend light. All three sit next to the exported Figma state, over the same background, with sliders for every setting. It's also how I picked the 3D cubes, and how I landed on the colours and the camera. This way helps make the user experience much nicer and the final product as close to the design as possible.

How I used AI. I did the research, the inspiration, the design, and the planning myself, including which tech stack, components, and libraries this would be built out of. Then I used Claude Code to develop it against that design and vision. Afterwards I went back through the code to fine-tune and clean it up.

With more time. I'd design multiple image upload, and a carousel or gallery of what's been uploaded in the same style as the zone. Real `XMLHttpRequest` progress too, instead of a simulated curve.